

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250281163

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 11, 2025

Inventor(s)

RHODES; Sidney

DYNAMIC RESOURCE RECONFIGURATION FOR PATIENT INTERFACE MODULE (PIM) IN INTRALUMINAL MEDICAL ULTRASOUND IMAGING

Abstract

Ultrasound image devices, systems, and methods are provided. An intraluminal ultrasound imaging system, comprising a patient interface module (PIM) in communication with an intraluminal imaging device comprising an ultrasound imaging component, the PIM comprising a first reconfigurable logic block including a first plurality of logic elements interconnected by first reconfigurable interconnection elements; a configuration memory coupled to the first reconfigurable logic block; and a processing component coupled to the configuration memory, the processing component configured to detect a device attribute of the intraluminal imaging device in communication with the PIM; and load at least one of a first configuration or a second configuration to the configuration memory based on the detected device attribute to configure one or more of the first reconfigurable interconnection elements such that the first plurality of logic elements are interconnected for communication with the ultrasound imaging component.

Inventors: RHODES; Sidney (ROSEVILLE, CA)

Applicant: PHILIPS IMAGE GUIDED THERAPY CORPORATION (SAN DIEGO, CA)

Family ID: 1000008626553

Appl. No.: 19/218976

Filed: May 27, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

parent US continuation 18375664 20231002 parent-grant-document US 12310796 child US 19218976

parent US continuation 16453966 20190626 parent-grant-document US 11771405 child US 18375664

us-provisional-application US 62690839 20180627

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **A61B8/00** (20060101); **A61B8/12** (20060101); **G16H30/40** (20180101); **G16H80/00** (20180101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **A61B8/56** (20130101); **A61B8/12** (20130101); **G16H30/40** (20180101); **G16H80/00** (20180101); **A61B8/4483** (20130101)

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 18/375,664, filed Oct. 2, 2023, now U.S. Pat. No. 12,310,796, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/453,966, filed Jun. 26, 2019, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,771,405, which claims priority to and the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/690,839, filed Jun. 27, 2018, each of which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates generally to intraluminal imaging devices, in particular, to providing a patient interface module (PIM) with reconfigurable hardware resources. For example, a PIM can include a field programmable gate array (FPGA) that can interface and control various intraluminal imaging devices. The FPGA can include reconfigurable logic blocks that can be dynamically reconfigured to communicate with an intraluminal imaging device based on a detection of a device attribute of the intraluminal device.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Intravascular ultrasound (IVUS) imaging is widely used in interventional cardiology as a diagnostic tool for assessing a diseased vessel, such as an artery, within the human body to determine the need for treatment, to guide the intervention, and/or to assess its effectiveness. An IVUS device including one or more ultrasound transducers is passed into the vessel and guided to the area to be imaged. The transducers emit ultrasonic energy in order to create an image of the vessel of interest. Ultrasonic waves are partially reflected by discontinuities arising from tissue structures (such as the various layers of the vessel wall), red blood cells, and other features of interest. Echoes from the reflected waves are received by the transducer and passed along to an IVUS imaging system. The imaging system processes the received ultrasound echoes to produce a cross-sectional image of the vessel where the device is placed. IVUS imaging can provide detailed and accurate measurements of lumen and vessel sizes, plaque areas and volumes, and location of key anatomical landmarks. IVUS imaging allows physicians to evaluate the size of a lesion, select a treatment device (e.g., a stent) based on the evaluated lesion size, and subsequently evaluate the treatment success.

[0004] There are two types of IVUS catheters commonly in use today: rotational and solid-state. For a typical rotational IVUS catheter, a single ultrasound transducer element is located at the tip of a flexible driveshaft that spins inside a plastic sheath inserted into the vessel of interest. The transducer element is oriented such that the ultrasound beam propagates generally perpendicular to the axis of the device. The fluid-filled sheath protects the vessel tissue from the spinning transducer and driveshaft while permitting ultrasound signals to propagate from the transducer into the tissue and back. As the driveshaft rotates, the transducer is periodically excited with a high voltage pulse to emit a short burst of ultrasound. The same transducer then listens for the returning echoes

reflected from various tissue structures. The IVUS imaging system assembles a two dimensional display of the vessel cross-section from a sequence of pulse/acquisition cycles occurring during a single revolution of the transducer.

[0005] Solid-state IVUS catheters carry an ultrasound imaging assembly that includes an array of ultrasound transducers distributed around its circumference along with one or more integrated circuit controller chips mounted adjacent to the transducer array. The solid-state IVUS catheters are also referred to as phased array IVUS transducers or phased array IVUS devices. The controllers select individual transducer elements (or groups of elements) for transmitting an ultrasound pulse and for receiving the ultrasound echo signal. By stepping through a sequence of transmit-receive pairs, the solid-state IVUS system can synthesize the effect of a mechanically scanned ultrasound transducer but without moving parts (hence the solid-state designation). Since there is no rotating mechanical element, the transducer array can be placed in direct contact with the blood and vessel tissue with minimal risk of vessel trauma.

[0006] Different clinical applications may require different types of IVUS catheters or different imaging modes. In other instances, different types of IVUS catheters or different imaging modes may be required during a clinical procedure. The different types of IVUS catheters may use different communication protocols for communications of commands, statuses, and data. The different communication protocols may use different number of communication signal lines (e.g., wires). The different types of IVUS catheters may communicate analog signals at different voltage levels. The different imaging modes (e.g., including imaging resolution, B-mode imaging, pulse-Doppler, continuous Doppler) may require different trigger signals for ultrasound wave emissions and ultrasound echo receptions.

[0007] In an IVUS imaging system, a PIM is typically used to interface a host system with an IVUS catheter. For example, the PIM can coordinate with the host system to control the operation of the IVUS catheter for imaging and the PIM can forward image signals captured by the IVUS catheter to the host system for processing and/or display. Different PIMs may be required for communications with different types of IVUS catheters (e.g., due to different communication protocols) and/or for different imaging procedures (e.g., due to different trigger sequences). One approach to avoid using different PIMs for different types of IVUS catheters may be to include multiple different hardware modules in the PIM to serve different IVUS catheter types and/or different imaging modes. However, such an approach may increase the amount of logics and/or memory resources in a PIM, and thus may lead to a higher cost and may increase the size of the PIM.

SUMMARY

[0008] While existing IVUS imaging system have proved useful, there remains a need for improved systems and techniques for real-time system reconfigurations. Embodiments of the present disclosure provide a PIM that includes a field programmable gate array (FPGA) including resources that can be dynamically reconfigured at run-time based on a device attribute of an IVUS catheter attached to the PIM. For example, the resources in the FPGA can be divided into a statically configured portion and a dynamically reconfigurable portion. The statically configured portion can implement functions or operations that are common across multiple different types of intraluminal imaging devices. The dynamically reconfigurable portion can implement functions or operations that are specific to a particular intraluminal imaging device. For example, in the reconfigurable portion, logic cells, logic blocks, and/or logic elements can be dynamically allocated and connection pins can be dynamically assigned to interface to a different IVUS catheter and/or provide a different sequencing algorithm.

[0009] In one embodiment, an intraluminal ultrasound imaging system is provided. The system includes a patient interface module (PIM) in communication with an intraluminal imaging device comprising an ultrasound imaging component, the PIM comprising a first reconfigurable logic block including a first plurality of logic elements interconnected by first reconfigurable

interconnection elements; a configuration memory coupled to the first reconfigurable logic block; and a processing component coupled to the configuration memory, the processing component configured to: detect a device attribute of the intraluminal imaging device in communication with the PIM; and load at least one of a first configuration or a second configuration to the configuration memory based on the detected device attribute to configure one or more of the first reconfigurable interconnection elements such that the first plurality of logic elements are interconnected for communication with the ultrasound imaging component.

[0010] In some embodiments, the processing component is further configured to load the first configuration when the detected device attribute indicates that the intraluminal imaging device comprises a first device attribute; and load the second configuration when the detected device attribute indicates that the intraluminal imaging device comprises a second device attribute, and wherein the first device attribute and the second device attribute are different. In some embodiments, the processing component is further configured to load the first configuration into the configuration memory based on the detection identifying the detected device attribute as the first device attribute. In some embodiments, the first configuration configures the first reconfigurable logic block to establish a digital communication link with the intraluminal imaging device based on a communication protocol associated with the detected device attribute; and transmit, via the digital communication link, a command to configure the intraluminal imaging device. In some embodiments, the first configuration configures the first reconfigurable logic block to establish a digital communication link with the intraluminal imaging device based on a communication protocol associated with the detected device attribute; and receive, via the digital communication link, a status of the intraluminal imaging device. In some embodiments, the first configuration configures the first reconfigurable logic block to receive, from the ultrasound imaging component based on the detected device attribute, an analog signal associated with an ultrasound echo signal received by the ultrasound imaging component, the ultrasound echo signal representative of a subject's body. In some embodiments, the first configuration configures the first reconfigurable logic block to apply a filter to the received analog signal based on the detected device attribute. In some embodiments, the first configuration configures the first reconfigurable logic block to convert the received analog signal to a digital signal based on the detected device attribute. In some embodiments, the PIM further includes a host interface configured to transmit an image signal associated with the ultrasound echo signal to a host. In some embodiments, the ultrasound imaging component includes an array of ultrasound transducers. In some embodiments, the system further comprises a second reconfigurable logic block including a second plurality of logic elements interconnected by second reconfigurable interconnection elements, wherein the processing component is further configured to load a third configuration or a fourth configuration to the configuration memory based on a target imaging mode of an ultrasound imaging procedure to configure the second reconfigurable interconnection elements such that the second plurality of logic elements are interconnected for applying a sequence of trigger signals to the array of ultrasound transducers for ultrasound wave emissions and ultrasound echo receptions. In some embodiments, the PIM further comprises a non-volatile storage memory configured to store the first configuration and the second configuration, and wherein the processing component is further configured to load the at least one of a first configuration or a second configuration to the configuration memory from the non-volatile storage memory. In some embodiments, the system further comprises a field programmable gate array (FPGA) including the first reconfigurable logic block; the configuration memory; and the processing component.

[0011] In one embodiment, a method of intraluminal ultrasound imaging is provided. The method includes detecting, by a patient interface module (PIM), a device attribute of an intraluminal imaging device in communication with the PIM, the intraluminal imaging device including an ultrasound imaging component; and loading, by a processing component of the PIM, at least one of a first configuration or a second configuration to a configuration memory of the PIM based on the

detected device attribute to configure a first reconfigurable logic block of the PIM, wherein the first reconfigurable logic block includes a first plurality of logic elements interconnected by first reconfigurable interconnection elements, and wherein the first configuration or the second configuration configures one or more of the first reconfigurable interconnection elements such that the first plurality of logic elements are interconnected for communication with the ultrasound imaging component.

[0012] In some embodiments, the first configuration is associated with a first device attribute, wherein the second configuration is associated with a second device attribute different from the first device attribute, and wherein the loading includes loading first configuration into the configuration memory based on the detection identifying the detected device attribute including the first device attribute. In some embodiments, the method further comprises establishing, via the first reconfigurable logic block based on the first configuration, a digital communication link with the intraluminal imaging device based on a communication protocol associated with the detected device attribute; and transmitting, via the digital communication link, a command to configure the intraluminal imaging device. In some embodiments, the first configuration configures the first reconfigurable logic block to receive, via the first reconfigurable logic block based on the first configuration, an analog signal associated with an ultrasound echo signal received by the ultrasound imaging component, the ultrasound echo signal representative of a subject's body. In some embodiments, the method further comprises transmitting an image signal associated with the ultrasound echo signal to a host. In some embodiments, the method further comprises loading, by the processing component, a third configuration or a fourth configuration to the configuration memory based on a target imaging mode of an ultrasound imaging procedure to configure a second reconfigurable logic block of the PIM, wherein the second reconfigurable logic block including a second plurality of logic elements interconnected by second reconfigurable interconnection elements, wherein the third configuration or the fourth configuration configures the second reconfigurable interconnection elements such that the second plurality of logic elements are interconnected for applying a sequence of trigger signals to an array of ultrasound transducers of the ultrasound imaging component for ultrasound wave emissions and ultrasound echo receptions. In some embodiments, the loading includes loading the at least one of a first configuration or a second configuration to the configuration memory from a non-volatile storage memory of the PIM.

[0013] Additional aspects, features, and advantages of the present disclosure will become apparent from the following detailed description.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0014] Illustrative embodiments of the present disclosure will be described with reference to the accompanying drawings, of which:

[0015] FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of an intraluminal ultrasound imaging system, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

[0016] FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram illustrating a system configuration for an intraluminal ultrasound imaging system, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

[0017] FIG. 3 is a schematic diagram illustrating a dynamic resource reconfiguration scheme for a patient interface module (PIM), according to aspects of the present disclosure.

[0018] FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram illustrating a device interface configuration for a PIM, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

[0019] FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram illustrating an ultrasound imaging configuration, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

[0020] FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram illustrating a system configuration for an intraluminal

ultrasound imaging system, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

[0021] FIG. 7 is a flow diagram of a method of ultrasound imaging, according to aspects of the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0022] For the purposes of promoting an understanding of the principles of the present disclosure, reference will now be made to the embodiments illustrated in the drawings, and specific language will be used to describe the same. It is nevertheless understood that no limitation to the scope of the disclosure is intended. Any alterations and further modifications to the described devices, systems, and methods, and any further application of the principles of the present disclosure are fully contemplated and included within the present disclosure as would normally occur to one skilled in the art to which the disclosure relates. In particular, it is fully contemplated that the features, components, and/or steps described with respect to one embodiment may be combined with the features, components, and/or steps described with respect to other embodiments of the present disclosure. For the sake of brevity, however, the numerous iterations of these combinations will not be described separately.

[0023] FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of an intraluminal ultrasound imaging system **100**, according to aspects of the present disclosure. The system **100** may include an intraluminal imaging device **102**, a patient interface module (PIM) **104**, a host system **106**, and a display **108**. The intraluminal imaging device **102** may be a catheter, a guide wire, or a guide catheter. The intraluminal imaging device **102** can be referred to as an interventional device and/or a diagnostic device, e.g., for use in a medical environment. In some instances, the intraluminal imaging device **102** can be a therapeutic device. The host system **106** may be a console, a computer, a laptop, a tablet, or a mobile device. The display **108** may be a monitor. In some embodiments, the display **108** may be an integrated component of the host system **106**.

[0024] The intraluminal imaging device **102** may include a flexible elongate member sized and shaped for insertion into the vasculature of a patient. The flexible elongate member may include a distal portion **131** and a proximal portion **132**. The intraluminal imaging device **102** may include an imaging component **110** mounted at the distal portion **131** near a distal end **133** of the intraluminal imaging device **102**. The intraluminal imaging device **102** may be inserted into a body lumen or vessel **120** of the patient. For example, the intraluminal imaging device **102** can be inserted into a patient's vessel **120** to capture images of the structure of the vessel **120**, measure the diameter and/or length of the vessel **120** to guide stent selection, and/or measure blood flow in the vessel **120**. The vessel **120** may be any artery or vein within a vascular system of a patient. In some embodiments, the vessel **120** may be a venous vessel, a pulmonary vessel, a coronary vessel, or a peripheral vessel.

[0025] In an embodiment, the imaging component **110** may include ultrasound transducers configured to emit ultrasonic energy towards the vessel **120**. The emission of the ultrasonic energy may be in the form of pulses. The ultrasonic energy is reflected by tissue structures and/or blood flows in the vessel **120** surrounding the imaging component **110**. The reflected ultrasound echo signals are received by the ultrasound transducers in the imaging component **110**. In some instances, the imaging component **110** may be configured for brightness-mode (B-mode) imaging to capture images of vessel structures or to measure vessel diameters and lengths for stent selection. In some other instances, the imaging component **110** may be configured for Doppler color flow imaging to provide blood flow measurements. In yet some other instances, the imaging component **110** may be configured to operate in a dual-mode to provide both B-mode imaging data and Doppler flow measurements.

[0026] In some embodiments, the ultrasound transducers in the imaging component are phased-array transducers, which may be configured to emit ultrasound energy at a frequency of about 10 megahertz (MHz), 20 MHz, 40 MHz, 45 MHz, and/or other suitable values, both larger and smaller. In some other embodiments, the imaging component **110** may be alternatively configured

to include a rotational transducer to provide similar functionalities. The PIM **104** transfers the received echo signals to the host system **106** where the ultrasound image is reconstructed and displayed on the display **108**. For example, the strengths or the amplitudes of the echo responses may be converted to brightness or intensity levels for gray-scale image display.

[0027] The host system **106** can include a processor and a memory. The host system **106** can be operable to facilitate the features of the system **100** described herein. For example, the processor can execute computer readable instructions stored on the non-transitory tangible computer readable medium.

[0028] The PIM **104** facilitates communication of signals between the host system **106** and the intraluminal imaging device **102**. This may include forwarding commands received from the host system **106** to the intraluminal imaging device **102** to control the operation of the imaging component **110** and forwarding status reports received from the intraluminal imaging device **102** to the host system **106**. In addition, the PIM **104** may generate control signals to configure the imaging component **110**, triggering transmitter circuits to cause the imaging component **110** to emit ultrasound waves, and transferring echo signals captured by the imaging component **110** to the host system **106**. With regard to the echo signals, the PIM **104** forwards the received signals and, in some embodiments, performs preliminary signal processing prior to transmitting the signals to the host **106**. In examples of such embodiments, the PIM **104** performs amplification, filtering, and/or aggregating of the data. In an embodiment, the PIM **104** also supplies high- and low-voltage direct current (DC) power to support operation of the circuitry within the imaging component **110**. Mechanisms for triggering the transmitter circuits are described in greater detail herein.

[0029] In an embodiment, the host system **106** receives the echo data from the imaging component **110** and/or transmits controls to the imaging component **110** by way of the PIM **104**. The host system **106** processes the echo data to reconstruct an image of the tissue structures in the vessel **120** surrounding imaging component **110**. The host system **106** outputs image data such that an image of the vessel **120**, such as a cross-sectional image of the vessel **120**, is displayed on the display **108**.

[0030] In some embodiments, the intraluminal imaging device **102** includes some features similar to traditional solid-state IVUS catheters, such as the EagleEye® Platinum, Eagle Eye® Platinum ST, Eagle Eye® Gold, and Visions® PV catheters available from Volcano Corporation and those disclosed in U.S. Pat. No. 7,846,101 hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety. For example, the intraluminal imaging device **102** further includes an electrical cable **112** extending along the longitudinal body of the intraluminal imaging device **102**. The cable **112** is a transmission line bundle including a plurality of conductors, including one, two, three, four, five, six, seven, or more conductors. It is understood that any suitable gauge wire can be used for the conductors. In an embodiment, the cable **112** can include a four-conductor transmission line arrangement with, e.g., 41 American wire gauge (AWG) wires. In an embodiment, the cable **112** can include a seven-conductor transmission line arrangement utilizing, e.g., 44 AWG wires. In some embodiments, 43 AWG wires can be used. In some other embodiments, the intraluminal imaging device **102** includes some features similar to traditional rotational IVUS catheters, such as the Revolution® catheter available from Volcano Corporation and those disclosed in U.S. Pat. Nos. 5,601,082 and 6,381,350, each of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety. In some embodiments, the intraluminal imaging device **102** includes components or features similar or identical to those disclosed in U.S. Pat. Nos. 4,917,097, 5,368,037, 5,453,575, 5,603,327, 5,779,644, 5,857,974, 5,876,344, 5,921,931, 5,938,615, 6,049,958, 6,085,410, 6,123,673, 6,165,128, 6,283,920, 6,309,339, 6,033,357, 6,457,365, 6,712,767, 6,725,081, 6,767,327, 6,776,763, 6,779,257, 6,785,415, 6,899,682, 6,962,567, 6,976,965, 7,097,620, 7,226,417, 7,641,485, 7,676,910, 7,711,413, and 7,736,317, each of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

[0031] The cable **112** terminates in a PIM connector **114** at a proximal end of the intraluminal imaging device **102**. The PIM connector **114** electrically couples the cable **112** to the PIM **104** and physically couples the intraluminal imaging device **102** to the PIM **104**. In an embodiment, the

intraluminal imaging device **102** further includes a guide wire exit port **116** disposed near a junction **130** at which the distal portion **131** is coupled to the proximal portion **132**. Accordingly, in some instances the intraluminal imaging device **102** is a rapid-exchange catheter. The guide wire exit port **116** allows a guide wire **118** to be inserted towards the distal end **133** in order to direct the intraluminal imaging device **102** through the vessel **120**.

[0032] Different clinical or imaging applications may require the use of different types of intraluminal imaging devices **102**, which may have different dimensions and/or different imaging capabilities. For example, imaging of peripheral vessels, imaging of coronary vessels, measurements of blood flow, and evaluations of vascular morphology in blood vessels may each require a particular type of intraluminal imaging device **102**. Different types of intraluminal imaging devices **102** (e.g., the EagleEye® Platinum, Eagle Eye® Platinum ST, Eagle Eye® Gold, Visions® PV, and/or Revolution® catheters available from Volcano Corporation) may communicate information (e.g., commands and statuses) using different number of physical signal lines, for example, to carry data, controls, addresses, and/or clock signals. In addition, the encoding of the data may be different depending on the communication protocols. For example, some intraluminal devices **102** may use a serial communication interface while other intraluminal devices **102** may use an inter-integrated circuit (I2C) interface. Further, the different types of intraluminal imaging devices **102** may require different trigger signals to control ultrasound wave emissions and/or ultrasound echo signals receptions at the imaging component **110**. For example, trigger signals for a phased-array imaging component **110** may be different from trigger signals for a rotational-based imaging component **110**.

[0033] Different clinical or imaging applications may use different imaging modes to acquire different type of diagnostic information (e.g., B-mode data and color Doppler flow data). Different ultrasound center frequencies may be used to compromise signal penetration depths and image resolutions. For example, the imaging component **110** may be configured to emit ultrasound waves at a higher center frequency to provide a higher imaging resolution, trading off penetration depth. Conversely, the imaging component **110** may be configured to emit ultrasound waves at a lower center frequency to provide a deeper penetration, trading off imaging resolution. Thus, different trigger signals may be required to trigger ultrasound transmit pulses of different center frequencies.

[0034] Different ultrasound pulse durations may be used for obtaining different imaging views. For example, the imaging component **110** may be configured to emit ultrasound pulses with a shorter duration, but at a higher signal energy level. For example, higher-energy ultrasound waves can be used during color flow imaging to provide a better view of blood vessel boundaries. Alternatively, higher-energy ultrasound waves can be used to provide a larger field-of-view during peripheral imaging due to the larger peripheral vessel sizes, for example, when capturing an image of an aorta artery during abdominal imaging or an iliac artery during limb imaging. Thus, different trigger signals may be required to trigger ultrasound transmit pulses of different durations and/or different energy levels.

[0035] As can be seen, different intraluminal imaging devices **102** may require different number of physical signal lines and communication protocols for data and/or signal transfers. In addition, different imaging components **110** and/or different target imaging modes may require trigger signals of different waveform characteristics (e.g., voltage levels, frequencies, and/or duty cycles) and of different trigger sequences. In an embodiment, the PIM **104** may include reconfigurable hardware resources that can be dynamically reconfigured in run-time based on an attached intraluminal imaging device **102**. For example, the PIM **104** can detect a device attribute (e.g., a device type and/or an ultrasound attribute) of the attached intraluminal imaging device **102** and configure the reconfigurable hardware resources accordingly. Mechanisms for dynamic hardware resource reconfiguration in the PIM **104** are described in greater detail herein.

[0036] FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram illustrating a system configuration **200** for the intraluminal ultrasound imaging system **100**, according to aspects of the present disclosure. FIG. 2 provides a

more detailed view of the internal components of the PIM **104** and interactions among the PIM **104**, the host **106**, and the intraluminal imaging device **102** in communication with the PIM **104**. FIG. **3** is a schematic diagram illustrating a dynamic resource reconfiguration scheme **300** for the PIM **104**, according to aspects of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. **2**, the PIM **104** includes a device connector **204** coupled to an FPGA **220**. At a high level, upon an attachment of an intraluminal imaging device **102** to the device connector **204**, the PIM **104** can detect and identify a device attribute of the attached intraluminal imaging device **102**. The PIM **104** can load a configuration bitstream onto the FPGA **220** at run-time to configure the FPGA **220** for communication with the attached intraluminal imaging device **102**.

[0037] The device connector **204** may be a common intraluminal imaging device connector suitable for coupling with various different intraluminal imaging devices **102**. The device connector **204** may include digital signal connections and analog signal connections coupled to an attached intraluminal imaging device **102** via a link **202**. The intraluminal imaging devices are shown as **102A**, **102B**, and **102C**. As an example, the intraluminal imaging device **102A** may be a rotational IVUS catheter including an imaging component **110A** with a single ultrasound transducer element. The intraluminal imaging device **102B** may be a solid-state IVUS catheter, for example, suitable for coronary imaging. The intraluminal imaging device **102C** may include an imaging component **110C** with phased-array ultrasound transducers. The intraluminal imaging device **102C** may be another solid-state IVUS catheter, for example, suitable for peripheral imaging. The intraluminal imaging device **102C** may include an imaging component **110C** with phased-array ultrasound transducers.

[0038] The different intraluminal imaging devices **102A**, **102B**, and **102C** may have different dimensions and/or different number of physical signal lines for communications. For example, the intraluminal device **102A** may communicate with the PIM **104** over four physical signal lines, while the intraluminal devices **102B** and **102C** may communicate with the PIM **104** over six physical signal lines. In some other instances, the different intraluminal imaging devices **102A**, **102B**, and **102C** may have the same number of physical signal lines, but may have different pin assignments for connections to the device connector **204**.

[0039] The different intraluminal imaging devices **102A**, **102B**, and **102C** may employ different communication protocols for digital communications and/or different voltage levels for transfer of analog and/or digital signals. For example, the intraluminal imaging device **102A** may employ an I2C communication protocol, while the intraluminal imaging device **102B** may employ a high-speed I2C communication protocol. In some instances, a digital signal for the intraluminal device **102A** may carry a 7-bit address field, an 8-bit data field, and 3 groups of 4-bit controls, while a digital signal for the intraluminal device **102B** and **102C** may carry a 3-bit address field, an 8-bit data field, and a 3-bit control field. In some instances, the intraluminal imaging device **102A** may communicate using differential signals, while the intraluminal device **102B** may communicate using common-mode signals.

[0040] The different intraluminal imaging devices **102A**, **102B**, and **102C** may have different imaging capabilities, such as different ultrasound center frequencies and/or different imaging cores (e.g., a phased-array or a rotational imaging core). The imaging components **110A**, **110B**, and **110C** may require different trigger signals for ultrasound wave emissions and/or ultrasound echo receptions. For example, the imaging components **110A**, **110B**, and **110C** may be designed to emit ultrasound waves with different center frequencies. In some embodiments, each intraluminal imaging device **102** may include a non-volatile memory configured to store device information, such as a serial number, a device identification number, a catheter type, and other device attributes (e.g., ultrasound attributes and/or a physiological sensing modality) related to a corresponding ultrasound imaging component **110**.

[0041] The FPGA **220** includes programmable fabric in the form of configurable logic cells or logic elements (e.g., logic elements **330** shown in FIG. **3**) and configurable switches or

interconnection elements (e.g., interconnection elements **332** shown in FIG. **3**). The logic elements may include multipliers, adders, flip-flops, and/or other logic gates. The configurable interconnection elements can be configured to interconnect the logic elements to provide a desired function (e.g., implementing a particular communication protocol or a particular sequence of operations). The configurable logic elements and configurable interconnection elements can be divided into two portions, a dynamically reconfigurable portion **222** and a statically configured portion **224**.

[0042] The statically configured portion **224** may implement modules or logic blocks that are common across the intraluminal imaging devices **102**. As shown, the statically configured portion **224** includes a flash interface **230**, a register array **232**, a processing component **234**, a configuration memory **236**, and a host interface **238**. The dynamically reconfigurable portion **222** may implement modules or logic blocks that are specific to an intraluminal imaging device **102** (e.g., the intraluminal imaging device **102C**) attached to the PIM **104**. As shown, the dynamically reconfigurable portion **222** includes a plurality of reconfigurable logic blocks **226**. The reconfigurable logic blocks **226A** and **226B** can be reconfigured at run-time for communication with the attached intraluminal imaging device **102** as described in greater detail herein.

[0043] The flash interface **230** is configured to communicate with an external flash memory. For example, the PIM **104** can further include a flash memory **210**. The flash memory **210** is a non-volatile memory, such as a flash memory card. The flash memory **210** is configured to store configuration data, which may be referred to as FPGA configuration bitstreams. The flash memory **210** can store partial configuration bitstreams. As shown in FIG. **3**, the flash memory **210** stores a plurality of configuration data **310** and a configuration data **320**. The configuration data **320** defines the locations and the switching of the interconnection elements in the statically configured portion **224**. For example, the configuration data **320** configures the statically configured portion **224** to implement the register array **232**, the processing component **234**, the configuration memory **236**, and the host interface **238**.

[0044] The configuration data **310** defines the locations and switching of the interconnection elements in the dynamically reconfigured portion **222**. Each configuration data **310** is associated with a specific attribute of an intraluminal imaging device **102**. As an example, the configuration data **310A** defines the locations and switching of the interconnection elements in the reconfigurable logic blocks **226A** and **226B** to implement a communication interface and a sequencer (e.g., for generating transmit/receive trigger signals) specific to the intraluminal imaging device **102A**. The configuration data **310B** defines the locations and switching of the interconnection elements in the reconfigurable logic blocks **226A** and **226B** to implement a communication interface and a sequencer specific to the intraluminal imaging device **102B**. The configuration data **310C** defines the locations and switching of the interconnection elements in the reconfigurable logic blocks **226A** and **226B** to implement a communication interface and a sequencer specific to the intraluminal imaging device **102C**, as described in greater detail herein.

[0045] The processing component **234** is coupled to the flash interface **230** and the register array **232**. The processing component **234** can be any type of central processing unit (CPU). In some instances, the processing component **234** can be a microcontroller, a general purpose processor (GPU), or a digital signal processor (DSP). The processing component **234** is configured to detect a device attribute of an intraluminal imaging device **102** attached to the PIM **104**. The device attribute can include a communication protocol (e.g., I2C, a high-speed I2C, or a serial communication link) used by the attached intraluminal imaging device **102** for communication. The device attribute can include an ultrasound attribute of the imaging component **110** of the intraluminal imaging device **102**. The ultrasound attribute may include an operational center frequency (e.g., of about 10 MHz, 20 MHz, 40 MHz, 45 MHz, and/or other suitable values, both larger and smaller) of the imaging component **110**. In addition, the ultrasound attribute may indicate an imaging core type of the imaging component **110**, for example, whether the imaging

component **110** is a phased-array ultrasound imaging component or a rotational ultrasound imaging component.

[0046] The processing component **234** can select a configuration from the plurality of configuration data **310** based on the detected device attribute. The processing component **234** can configure the dynamically reconfigurable portion **222** of FPGA **220** based on the detected device attribute. As shown in FIG. **3**, the processing component **234** can load the selected configuration data **302** via the flash interface **230** and the register array **232** into the configuration memory **236**. The configuration memory **236** and the register array **232** can be any random access memory (RAM). For example, the selected configuration data **302** is received at the register array **232** as shown by the arrow **304**. The configuration data **302** is transferred from the register array **232** into the configuration memory **234** as shown by the arrow **306**. The configuration data **302** stored in the configuration memory **234** is used to configure the interconnection elements **332** to interconnect the logic elements **330** in a reconfigurable logic block **226**, for example, to implement a communication interface or a sequencer for the attached intraluminal imaging device **102**. The configuration data **310** are referred to as a partial FPGA bitstream. In some embodiments, the processing component **234** can form a full FPGA bitstream including the configuration data **320** (e.g., static or common among intraluminal imaging devices **102**) and the selected configuration data **302** (e.g., the configuration data **310C**) and load the full FPGA bitstream into the configuration memory **234**. While FIG. **3** illustrates four logic elements **330** for simplicity of discussion, the reconfigurable logic block **226** can be scaled to include any suitable number of logic elements **330**. [0047] In some embodiments, the FPGA **220** can further include a device detection logic block that can detect an attachment of an intraluminal imaging device **102** to the PIM **104** and notify the processing component **234** of the detection.

[0048] The host interface **238** may include hardware components and/or software components configured to communicate with the host **106** via a link **208**. In some instances, the communication link **208** may be a wired connection, such as an Ethernet link, a universal serial bus (USB) link, or any suitable wired communication link. In other instances, the link **208** may be a wireless link, such as an Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) 802.11 (WiFi) link, a Bluetooth link, a Zigbee link, or an ultra-wideband (UWB) link. The host interface **238** can be coupled to the reconfigurable logic blocks **226**. For example, the host **106** can send commands to the attached intraluminal imaging device **102** and receive echo signals or image signals via the host interface **238** and the reconfigurable logic blocks **226**.

[0049] As an example, when the intraluminal imaging device **102A** is connected to the PIM **104**, the processing component **234** can automatically identify a device attribute of the intraluminal imaging device **102A**. The processing component **234** can load the configuration data **310A** into the configuration memory **236** to dynamically reconfigure the reconfigurable logic blocks **226** in run-time to implement at least a communication interface for communicating with the intraluminal imaging device **102A** and a sequencer for controlling the imaging component **110A**. After the reconfigurable logic blocks **226** are configured, the reconfigurable logic block **226A** functions as an analog interface and/or a digital interface for communicating with the intraluminal imaging device **102A**. For example, the PIM **104** can send commands **240** (e.g., reset, restart, and/or stop) to the imaging component **110A** and can receive statuses **242** (e.g., high-voltage (HV) out of range and/or sensor element failures) from the imaging component **110A** via the reconfigurable logic blocks **226**. The reconfigurable logic block **226A** can also receive ultrasound echo signals **244** captured by the imaging component **110A**. The reconfigurable logic block **226B** functions as a sequencer to generate a sequence of trigger signals **246** to control ultrasound wave emissions and ultrasound echo receptions at the imaging component **110A**. The trigger signals **246** may include one or more trigger signals for activating ultrasound wave emissions and/or one or more trigger signals for activating ultrasound echo receptions.

[0050] Alternatively, when the intraluminal imaging device **102B** is connected to the PIM **104**, the

processing component **234** can automatically identify a device attribute of the intraluminal imaging device **102B**. The processing component **234** can load the configuration data **310B** into the configuration memory **236** to dynamically reconfigure the reconfigurable logic blocks **226** in run-time to implement at least a communication interface for communicating with the intraluminal imaging device **102B** and a sequencer for controlling the imaging component **110B**. After the reconfigurable logic blocks **226** are configured, the reconfigurable blocks **226A** and **226B** can provide similar functionalities as described above, but specific to the intraluminal imaging device **102B**.

[0051] While FIGS. **2** and **3** illustrate a single configuration data **310** for reconfiguring the dynamically reconfigurable portion **222** of the FPGA **220**, in some embodiments, the configuration data for the interface and the configuration data for the sequencer can be stored as separate configuration data **310**.

[0052] FIG. **4** is a schematic diagram illustrating a device interface configuration **400** for the PIM **104**, according to aspects of the present disclosure. The configuration **400** provides a more detailed view of an example of a reconfigurable logic block **226A** configured to function as a communication interface for communicating with an intraluminal imaging device **102**. FIG. **4** illustrates the interface portion of the PIM **104** for simplicity of discussion, but may include other logic blocks as described above with respect to FIGS. **2** and **3**. As shown, the interface includes a digital path **402** and an analog path **404**. The digital path **402** is coupled to a digital interface block **410**. The analog path **404** is coupled to an analog filter **420**, an analog-to-digital converter (ADC) **430**, and a signal processing block **440**. The digital interface block **410**, the ADC **430**, and the signal processing block **440** can be implemented by the reconfigurable logic block **226A**. While FIG. **4** illustrates one analog filter **420** and one ADC **430**, the PIM **104** may include any suitable number of analog filters **420** and ADCs **430**.

[0053] As described above, the PIM **104** can exchange commands **240** and statuses **242** with an attached intraluminal imaging device **102**. The commands **240** and the statuses **242** can be communicated over the digital path **402**. The digital interface block **410** can be configured to implement a communication protocol (e.g., I2C, high-speed I2C, or any serial communication scheme) of the attached intraluminal imaging device **102C**. The communication protocol may include specific voltage levels, signal types, and/or data coding schemes.

[0054] The PIM **104** can also receive ultrasound echo signals **244** captured by the imaging component **110** of the attached intraluminal imaging device **102**. The echo signals **244** can be transferred over the analog path **404**. The echo signals **244** are analog radio frequency (RF) signals. The analog filter **420** can condition a received echo signal **244**. The ADC **430** can convert an analog signal to a digital signal for subsequent digital signal processing. In some instances, the analog filter **420** may be an antialiasing filter for the ADC **430**. The analog filter **420** can be a band pass filter, where the filter characteristics (e.g., the 3 decibel (dB) roll-off and bandwidth) may be dependent on the bandwidth of the ultrasound echo signal **244**, the center frequency of an ultrasound wave emission that causes the echo signal **244**, and/or a sampling rate of the ADC **430**. The signal processing block **440** can perform preprocessing to condition the echo signal **244** for further image processing. In some embodiments, the signal processing block **440** can include a digital filter (e.g., a notch filter) specific to the imaging component **110** of the attached intraluminal imaging device **102**. In some embodiments, the signal processing block **440** can implement an envelope detection algorithm and/or a logarithmic compressions algorithm for B-mode processing. In some embodiments, the signal processing block **440** can implement an image analysis algorithm (e.g., boundary detection and/or blood flow estimation). In some embodiments, the analog path **404** can further include an analog amplifier for amplifying the received echo signal **244** and/or other mixer circuitry for converting the RF echo signal **244** into a baseband signal prior to the ADC **430**. In some embodiments, the ADC **430** can be an ADC external to the FPGA **220**.

[0055] FIG. **5** is a schematic diagram illustrating an ultrasound imaging configuration **500**,

according to aspects of the present disclosure. The configuration **500** provides a more detailed view of an example of a reconfigurable logic block **226B** configured to function as a sequencer for controlling ultrasound wave emissions and ultrasound echo receptions at an imaging component **110** of an attached intraluminal imaging device **102**. For example, the reconfigurable logic block **226B** can control transmit and/or receive triggers to provide synthetic aperture ultrasound imaging. The configuration **500** includes a multiplexer **520** coupled to the imaging component **110**, a sequencer block **530**, and a trigger signal generation block **540**. The imaging component **110** may correspond to an imaging component **110C** of the intraluminal imaging device **102C** attached to the PIM **104** shown in FIG. 2. The imaging component **110** may include an array of ultrasound transducers **510**. The sequencer block **530** and the trigger signal generation block **540** can be implemented by the reconfigurable logic block **226B**.

[0056] The multiplexer **520** may include a plurality of transmit switching circuitries **522**. Each transmit switching circuitry **522** may be coupled to one of the transducers **510**. Each transmit switching circuitry **522** may include a driver that can activate ultrasound wave emissions at transducers **510** and a switch that can gate or allow an electrical signal (e.g., a trigger signal **246**) to pass through to a corresponding transducer **510**.

[0057] The sequencer block **530** controls the timing and the sequence of activations at the transducers **510** (e.g., for emitting ultrasound waves) and the trigger signal generation block **540** generates trigger signals to activate the transducers **510** based on a detected device attribute or ultrasound attribute of the imaging component **110**. The transmit switching circuitries **522** in the multiplexer **520** may receive trigger signals **246** from the trigger signal generation block **540** and send the trigger signals **228** through to the transducers **510** according to the timing and sequence provided by the sequencer block **530**. For example, the sequencer block **530** may provide a timing sequence **532** indicating a sequence (e.g., including an order and timing) for firing a set of transducers **510**.

[0058] In some embodiments, the transducers **510** may be grouped into apertures **504**, including apertures **504a** and **504b**. In some embodiments, each transducer **510** may be part of one or more apertures **504**. Each aperture **504** may include any suitable number of transducers **510**. The sequencer block **530** may activate one or more transducers **510** in an aperture **504** to emit ultrasound waves **502** (e.g., ultrasound transmit pulses). The ultrasound waves **502** may be emitted towards a target anatomical structure **505** (e.g., a blood vessel). While not shown in FIG. 5, the configuration **500** may further include receive switching circuitries coupled to the transducer so that the sequencer block **530** may also activate one or more transducers **510** in the aperture **504** to receive echo signals **503** reflected back from the structure **505**. The received echo signals **503** may create an A-line in an image representing the structure **505**.

[0059] While the multiplexer **520** is illustrated with a separate transmit switching circuitry **522** for each transducer **510**, the transmit switching circuitries **522** can be configured in any suitable configuration, for example, some transducers **510** may be coupled to the same transmit switching circuitry **522**. In addition, in some embodiments, the sequencer block **530** may be coupled to the trigger signal generation block **540** and the trigger signal generation block **540** can apply encoded trigger signals to the imaging component **110**. The encoded trigger signals can further include information indicating the transducers **510** selected by the sequencer block **530**.

[0060] FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram illustrating a system configuration **600** for the intraluminal ultrasound imaging system **100**, according to aspects of the present disclosure. The system configuration **600** may be substantially similar to the system configuration **200**. For example, the PIM **104** can detect an attachment of an intraluminal imaging device **102C**, identify a device attribute of the attached intraluminal imaging device **102**, and dynamically configure the dynamically reconfigurable portion **222** of the FPGA **220**. However, in the system configuration **600**, the PIM **104** may include an additional memory **620** external to the FPGA **220** and statically configured portion **224** can include an additional external memory interface **610**. The memory **620**

can be any RAM and may include a large storage size (e.g., a few megabytes to a few gigabytes). The external memory interface **610** may be coupled to the internal blocks of the FPGA **220** and may provide an interface for the FPGA **220** to read from the memory **620** or write to the memory **620**. For example, the signal processing block **440** can implement more complex signal processing and/or image processing algorithms, such as beamforming or focusing algorithms. The complex algorithms may require additional memory for storing working data. The working data can be transferred to the memory **620** via the external memory interface **610**.

[0061] FIG. 7 is a flow diagram of a method **700** of ultrasound imaging, according to aspects of the disclosure. Steps of the method **700** can be executed by the system **100**. The method **700** may employ similar mechanisms as in the system configurations **200**, **400**, **500**, and **600** and the scheme **300** as described with respect to FIGS. 2, 4, 5, 6, and 3, respectively. As illustrated, the method **700** includes a number of enumerated steps, but embodiments of the method **700** may include additional steps before, after, and in between the enumerated steps. In some embodiments, one or more of the enumerated steps may be omitted or performed in a different order.

[0062] At step **710**, the method includes detecting, by a PIM (e.g., the PIM **104**), a device attribute of an intraluminal imaging device (e.g., the intraluminal imaging device **102**) in communication with the PIM, the intraluminal imaging device including an ultrasound imaging component (e.g., the imaging component **110**). The device attribute can include information associated with a communication protocol, a signal type (e.g., differential or common-mode), and/or a voltage level used by the intraluminal imaging device for communications and/or an ultrasound attribute (e.g., a center frequency, an imaging core such as a phased-array or a rotational core) of the imaging component.

[0063] At step **720**, the method **700** includes loading, by a processing component (e.g., the processing component **234**) of the PIM, at least one of a first configuration (e.g., the configuration data **310A**) or a second configuration (e.g., the configuration data B) to a configuration memory (e.g., the configuration memory **236**) of the PIM based on the detected device attribute to configure a first reconfigurable logic block (e.g., the reconfigurable logic blocks **226A**) of the PIM. The first reconfigurable logic block includes a first plurality of logic elements (e.g., the logic elements **330**) interconnected by first reconfigurable interconnection elements (e.g., the interconnection elements **332**). The first configuration or the second configuration configures one or more of the first reconfigurable interconnection elements such that the first plurality of logic elements are interconnected for communication with the ultrasound imaging component.

[0064] In some embodiments, the first configuration is associated with a first device attribute and the second configuration is associated with a second device attribute different from the first device attribute. The loading includes loading first configuration into the configuration memory based on the detection identifying the detected device attribute including the first device attribute. In some instances, the first configuration is loaded from a non-volatile storage memory (e.g., the flash memory **210**) of the PIM.

[0065] In some embodiments, the method **700** can include establishing, via the first reconfigurable logic block based on the first configuration, a digital communication link (e.g., the digital path **402**) with the intraluminal imaging device based on a communication protocol associated with the detected device attribute. The PIM can transmit, via the digital communication link, a command (e.g., the commands **240**) to configure the intraluminal imaging device.

[0066] In some embodiments, the first configuration can configure the first reconfigurable logic block to receive, via the first reconfigurable logic block based on the first configuration, an analog signal associated with an ultrasound echo signal (e.g., the echo signal **244**) received by the ultrasound imaging component. The ultrasound echo signal representative of a subject's body (e.g., the vessel **120** or the structure **305**). The method **700** can further include transmitting an image signal associated with the ultrasound echo signal to a host (e.g., the host **106**).

[0067] In some embodiments, the method **700** can include loading, by the processing component, a

third configuration or a fourth configuration to the configuration memory based on a target imaging mode (e.g., B-mode or Color Doppler mode) of an ultrasound imaging procedure to configure a second reconfigurable logic block (e.g., the reconfigurable logic block **226B**) of the PIM. The second reconfigurable logic block includes a second plurality of logic elements interconnected by second reconfigurable interconnection elements. The third configuration or the fourth configuration can configure the second reconfigurable interconnection elements such that the second plurality of logic elements are interconnected for applying a sequence of trigger signals to an array of ultrasound transducers (e.g., the transducers **510**) of the ultrasound imaging component for ultrasound wave emissions (e.g., the ultrasound waves **502**) and ultrasound echo receptions (e.g., the ultrasound echo signals **503**).

[0068] Aspects of the present disclosure can provide several benefits. For example, the automatic detection of a device attribute of an intraluminal ultrasound imaging device **102** upon attachment to the PIM **104** can allow the PIM **104** to reconfigure the resources for communicating and/or controlling the attached intraluminal ultrasound imaging device **102** in run-time. Thus, the PIM **104** is not required to include resources for multiple different combinations of implementations for supporting different types of intraluminal imaging devices. As such, the dynamic reconfiguration of resources enables the PIM **104** to have a small footprint and a low cost. The dynamic resource configuration also enables the implementation of complex algorithms based on the intraluminal imaging device in use, rather than unnecessarily occupying resources while using another intraluminal imaging device. For example, the reconfigurable logic blocks can be configured to implement different sequencing algorithms based on the intraluminal imaging device in use and the desired diagnostic information.

[0069] Persons skilled in the art will recognize that the apparatus, systems, and methods described above can be modified in various ways. Accordingly, persons of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that the embodiments encompassed by the present disclosure are not limited to the particular exemplary embodiments described above. In that regard, although illustrative embodiments have been shown and described, a wide range of modification, change, and substitution is contemplated in the foregoing disclosure. It is understood that such variations may be made to the foregoing without departing from the scope of the present disclosure. Accordingly, it is appropriate that the appended claims be construed broadly and in a manner consistent with the present disclosure.

Claims

1. An intravascular ultrasound (IVUS) imaging system, comprising: an IVUS imaging catheter configured to be positioned inside a blood vessel and comprising one or more ultrasound transducers; and a patient interface module (PIM) comprising a field programmable gate array (FPGA), wherein the FPGA itself is configured to operate as a trigger signal generator for B-mode imaging of the blood vessel and color flow imaging of the blood vessel, wherein, when the FPGA operates as the trigger signal generator for the B-mode imaging of the blood vessel, the FPGA is configured to generate a first trigger signal to cause the one or more ultrasound transducers to emit, for B-mode imaging, ultrasound transmit pulses with a first energy level and a first duration, wherein, when the FPGA operates as the trigger signal generator for the color flow imaging, the FPGA is configured to generate a different, second trigger signal to cause the one or more ultrasound transducers to emit, for the color flow imaging, ultrasound transmit pulses with a second energy level higher than the first energy level and a second duration shorter than the first duration.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the FPGA comprises one or more dynamically reconfigurable portions that are reconfigurable to operate as the trigger signal generator for the B-mode imaging or as the trigger signal generator for the color flow imaging.
3. The system of claim 2, wherein the PIM is configured to: select a first configuration for the one

or more dynamically reconfigurable portions to operate as the trigger signal generator for the B-mode imaging or a second configuration for the one or more dynamically reconfigurable portions to operate as the trigger signal generator for the color flow imaging.

4. The system of claim 3, wherein the FPGA comprises a plurality of interconnection elements and a plurality of logic elements, wherein, to reconfigure the one or more dynamically reconfigurable portions, the PIM is configured to change how the plurality of interconnection elements provide interconnection for the plurality of logic elements.

5. The system of claim 4, wherein the first configuration or the second configuration define how the plurality of interconnection elements provide the interconnection for the plurality of logic elements.

6. The system of claim 3, wherein the PIM comprises a first memory configured to store the first configuration and the second configuration, wherein the first memory is distinct from the FPGA.

7. The system of claim 6, wherein the FPGA comprises a statically configured portion, wherein the statically configured portion comprises a processor and a second memory, wherein the processor is configured to load the first configuration or the second configuration into the second memory.

8. The system of claim 1, further comprising a host configured to: generate a circumferential image of the blood vessel based on at least one of the B-mode imaging or the color flow imaging; and output the circumferential image of the blood vessel to a display.

9. The system of claim 1, wherein the one or more ultrasound transducers comprise a rotational transducer or a transducer array.
